Legend: ○ single choice, □ multiple choice.

Settings

- activate 'Leave and delete my data.'
- activate backwards function ('Back' button)

Data handling, security and analysis

- consider implementing the survey in home institution's Gender Equality Plan, if possible
- consult with data security co-ordinator of home institution
- create folder on internal server, create own soscisurvey account (all via spokesperson)
- found analysis team (not too many people), those should be defined upfront and named in survey
- Analysis rules:
  - '*Rule of 5*': only report items or item combinations, in case of ≥5 inputs
  - Only analysis team accesses data; once analysis is finished, only spokesperson keeps data access.
- determine reporting formate (e.g., forthcoming Gender Equality Plan)
- Data storage
  - At maximum, 10 years
  - At minimum, for forthcoming two cycles of the home institutions Gender Equality Plan
- present to institute management (in general, keep management in the loop).

Information and promotion

- Physical posters (DIN-A3) and Flyers (DIN-A5) (english / german) with QR code
- Short slidedeck (5 slides) for promotion in units of home institution → reach out to heads of units to offer 5-min information session and/or circulation of slidedeck
- offer contact points
  - Email address
  - Anonymous: physical notes via home institution's Hauspost to spokesperson
  - 30-min Live Q&A sessions
    (2–3 weeks after launch; english / german)
- Notification in newsletter of home institution (including contact points)

Items

Page 1 (Onboarding and Information)

Hello!
Thank you so much for your interest in participating in the [Survey name (internal database number/code of home institution via which data is stored)].

Purpose of this survey
This survey aims to investigate intersectionality amongst individuals who work at the [home institution] in [City]. Intersectionality refers to the interconnected nature of social categorizations such as gender or internationality/ethnicity, which can create overlapping systems of discrimination or privilege. In addition to the currently collected facets, [primarily sex and gender, *check-whether-this-is-true-for-your-home-institution (Source, e.g., Gender Equality Plan of your home institution)*], the survey aims to include further dimensions. The study will be used to monitor changes in diversity and inclusion at the [home institution] over time.

The [home institution's Gender Equality Plan] can be downloaded here: [URL].

Benefit of the survey
The survey will support the institute to examine the dimensions of identity, including age, internationality/ethnicity, educational level of guardian(s) during youth, disability, or gender and sexual orientation, to identify potential barriers and promote inclusion. After data collection, the results will be reported in an aggregated and anonymised form in [your reporting formate, e.g., the next Gender Equality Plan]. [Additionally, the results are used as a baseline for comparison for the then subsequent Gender Equality Plan, illustrating changes in **diversity and inclusion** across the institute and across time, *check-whether-this-is-true-for-your-home-institution*]. Further, the results will provide **evidence** to move beyond general improvements and toward **informed decisions and measures** that specifically enhance the working environment.

Response to all items is strictly voluntary; participants are encouraged to answer only those questions they feel

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comfortable with and may choose to withhold responses to any specific question.

Who conducts the survey?
The survey is conducted by the [committee] of [home institution], and is run via the SoSci [URL] account of their spokesperson [name, email address].
Next, the survey will direct you to further information about how data will be used and stored. Any questions can be directed to [email address].

++++++++++++++++

Hallo!

Herzlichen Dank für Ihr Interesse an dieser [Survey name (internal database number/code of home institution via which data is stored)].

Zweck der Umfrage
Diese Umfrage dient dazu, die Intersektionalität unter den Beschäftigten des [home institution] in [City] zu untersuchen. Intersektionalität bezieht sich auf die Verflechtung sozialer Kategorien wie Gender oder internationale/ethnische Herkunft, die zu sich überschneidenden Systemen von Diskriminierung oder Privilegien führen können. Zusätzlich zu den derzeit erfassten Aspekten, vor allem [biologisches Geschlecht und Geschlechtsidentität, *check-whether-this-is-true-for-your-home-institution (Source, e.g., Gender Equality Plan of your home institution)*], sollen weitere Dimensionen in die Umfrage aufgenommen werden. Die Studie wird dazu dienen, Veränderungen in Bezug auf Diversität und Inklusion am [home institution] im Laufe der Zeit zu beobachten.

Der [home institution's Gender Equality Plan] kann hier heruntergeladen werden: [URL].

Nutzen der Befragung
Die Umfrage wird das [home institution] dabei unterstützen, die Dimensionen der Identität, einschließlich Alter, internationale/ethnische Herkunft, Bildungsabschluss der Erziehungsberechtigten, Behinderung, oder Geschlecht und sexueller Orientierung, zu untersuchen, um potenzielle Hindernisse zu identifizieren und die Inklusion zu fördern. Nach der Datenerhebung werden die Ergebnisse in aggregierter und anonymisierter Form im [your reporting formate, e.g., the next Gender Equality Plan] veröffentlicht. [Zusätzlich sollen Ergebnisse genutzt werden, um für den übernächsten Gleichstellungsplan als Vergleich agieren zu können, um Veränderungen in Bezug auf **Vielfalt und Inklusion** innerhalb des Instituts und im Zeitverlauf zu veranschaulichen, *check-whether-this-is-true-for-your-home-institution*]. Darüber hinaus liefern die Ergebnisse **Erkenntnisse**, um über allgemeine Verbesserungen hinauszugehen und **fundierte Entscheidungen und Maßnahmen** zu treffen, die speziell das Arbeitsumfeld verbessern.

Die Beantwortung aller Fragen ist streng freiwillig; die Teilnehmenden sind dazu eingeladen, nur jene Fragen zu beantworten, bei denen sie sich wohlfühlen, und können einzelne Fragen jederzeit unbeantwortet lassen.

Wer führt diese Umfrage durch?
Diese Umfrage wird vom [committee] des [home institution] durchgeführt und läuft über den SoSci Account der Person in Sprecher:innen-Funktion [name, email address].

Auf der nächsten Seite finden Sie weitere Informationen bezüglich der Verwendung und Speicherung von Daten. Bei weiteren Fragen, kontaktieren Sie gerne [email address].

NEXT

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Legend: ○ single choice, □ multiple choice.

Page 2 (Informed Consent)

Information on Data Protection and Participation

Survey Procedure
This is a single assessment that takes only a few minutes to complete (in total, **8 items**). All responses are confidential and will be analyzed only in aggregated form in order to help the institute better understand its community and promote inclusion and equity. Please refrain from filling out this survey multiple times. Participation is voluntary, you may withdraw at any time.

Platform used: SoSci
SoSci is a web-based platform for creating and conducting questionnaires. For participation in this survey, you are currently reading the survey information digitally. Only if you agree with the provided information, you are able to continue with the survey. This survey contains sensitive questions about **age, internationality/ethnicity, educational level of guardian(s) during youth, disability, as well as gender and sexual orientation**.

*For each question, you may refrain from answering by choosing the option "**I don't want to answer**"*.

Data security
This survey is conducted by the [committee] of [home institution] via the SoSci platform (SoSci Survey GmbH) and stored on servers of [*insert-what-applies-to-your-home-institution*]. All data transfers are encrypted, and no personal data will be shared with third parties. After the completion of data collection, all data will be transferred to the internal servers of the [home institution (internal database number/code of home institution via which data is stored)] and deleted from [*insert-what-applies-to-your-home-institution*] servers. The data will be retained until publication of the survey of the [*insert-what-applies-to-your-home*-institution, e.g., subsequent two cycles of the Gender Equality Plan], and for a maximum duration of [*insert-what-applies-to-your-home*-institution, e.g., 10] years.
All collected data will be processed with strict confidentiality and access will be limited to the [*list-names-of-analysis-team*] of the [committee] for the purpose of analysis. Following analysis completion (in [*insert-year*]), only the spokesperson of the [committee] will have access to the data.

Your personal information: Privacy and data handling
To protect your identity and ensure the anonymity of the results, we apply a "**Rule of 5**" to every level of our reporting:
- Dimension Levels: We only report results for a specific sub-category (e.g., a specific age group or gender identity) if it contains at least **5 participants**.
- Intersectional Facets: We only report on the overlap of multiple identities (e.g., a specific ethnicity within a specific age range) if that combined group includes at least **5 participants**.
- Anonymization: If a specific level or intersection does not meet this minimum, the data will be aggregated into a broader group or suppressed. This prevents "deductive identification", ensuring no individual can be recognized by their unique combination of traits in the final report.

Further information on data protection can be found at https://www.soscisurvey.de/en/data-protection.

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Informationen zum Datenschutz und zur Teilnahme

Ablauf der Umfrage
Dies ist eine einmalige Erhebung, deren Bearbeitung nur wenige Minuten in Anspruch nimmt (insgesamt **8 Items**). Alle Antworten sind vertraulich und werden nur in aggregierter Form analysiert, um dem Institut zu helfen, seine Gemeinschaft besser zu verstehen und Inklusion sowie Chancengerechtigkeit zu fördern. Bitte füllen Sie diese Umfrage nicht mehrfach aus. Die Teilnahme ist freiwillig, Sie können sie jederzeit abbrechen.

Verwendete Plattform: SoSci
SoSci ist eine webbasierte Plattform zur Erstellung und Durchführung von Fragebögen. Für die Teilnahme an dieser Umfrage lesen Sie derzeit die Umfrageinformationen in digitaler Form. Nur wenn Sie den bereitgestellten Informationen zustimmen, können Sie die Umfrage fortsetzen. Diese Umfrage enthält sensible Fragen zu **Alter, internationaler/ethnischer Herkunft, Bildungsabschluss der Erziehungsberechtigten, Behinderung, sowie Geschlecht und sexueller Orientierung**.

*Bei jeder Frage können Sie die Beantwortung überspringen, indem Sie die Option „**I don't want to answer**" auswählen.*

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Legend: ○ single choice, □ multiple choice.

Datensicherheit
Diese Umfrage wird vom [committee] des [home institution] über die Plattform SoSci (SoSci Survey GmbH) durchgeführt und auf den Servern von [*insert-what-applies-to-your-home-institution*] gespeichert. Alle Datenübertragungen sind verschlüsselt, und es werden keine personenbezogenen Daten an Dritte weitergegeben. Nach Abschluss der Datenerhebung werden alle Daten auf die internen Server des [home institution (internal database number/code of home institution via which data is stored)] übertragen und von den [*insert-what-applies-to-your-home-institution*] Servern gelöscht. Die Daten werden für die Dauer der [*insert-what-applies-to-your-home*-institution, e.g., subsequent two cycles of the Gender Equality Plan], und für maximal [*insert-what-applies-to-your-home*-institution, e.g., 10] Jahre gespeichert.
Alle erhobenen Daten werden streng vertraulich behandelt und der Zugriff ist zu Analysezwecken auf [*list-names-of-analysis-team*] des [committee] beschränkt. Nach Abschluss der Analysen (in [*insert-year*]) wird ausschließlich die Person in Sprecher:innen-Funktion des [committee] Zugriff auf die Daten haben.

Ihre persönlichen Informationen: Privatsphäre und Datenverarbeitung
Um Ihre Identität zu schützen und die Anonymität der Ergebnisse zu gewährleisten, wenden wir für jede Ebene unserer Berichterstattung eine „**5er-Regel**“ an:
- Ebenen der Dimensionen: Wir berichten Ergebnisse für eine spezifische Unterkategorie (z. B. eine bestimmte Altersgruppe oder Geschlechtsidentität) nur dann, wenn diese mindestens **5 Teilnehmende** umfasst.
- Intersektionale Merkmale: Wir berichten über die Überschneidung mehrerer Identitäten (z. B. eine bestimmte internationale/ethnische Herkunft innerhalb einer Altersgruppe) nur dann, wenn diese kombinierte Gruppe ebenfalls mindestens **5 Teilnehmende** umfasst.
- Anonymisierung: Wenn eine bestimmte Ebene oder Überschneidung dieses Minimum nicht erreicht, werden die Daten in einer breiteren Gruppe zusammengefasst oder unterdrückt. Dies verhindert eine „deduktive Re-Identifizierung“ und stellt sicher, dass im fertigen Bericht keine Person anhand ihrer einzigartigen Merkmalskombination erkannt werden kann.

Weitere Informationen zum Datenschutz finden Sie unter https://www.soscisurvey.de/de/data-protection.

1. Agreement
I have read and agree with the information and conditions of this survey.
Ich habe die Informationen und Konditionen gelesen und bin einverstanden.
o Yes, I agree. / Ja, ich stimme zu.
o No, I do not agree. / Nein, ich stimme nicht zu.

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Legend: ○ single choice, ☐ multiple choice.

Page 3

1. Which unit of staff do you belong to?
Please take note that the groups were formed according to standard Gender Equality Plan reporting.
Please reply according to this dichotomy even if you regard your position and your day-to-day activities to be matching the respective other group.
o **Science-supporting staff**: […]
o **Scientific staff**: […]

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Page 4 / 5 / 6 (rotated)

1. What is your citizenship?
☐ Citizen outside the European Union
☐ Citizen within the European Union (but not German)
☐ German
☐ I don't want to answer

2. Geographic areas of origin (of the last two generations)
Please select **all** the geographic areas from which your close relatives (of the **last two generations**) originate from. Note: This refers to the countries where your parents and grandparents were born or raised.

This means, please indicate all that applies for:
- Your guardians/parents
- Their parents/Your grandparents

In case the options do not fit, use the 'self-describe' option.

Source: United Nations' M49 Standard (unstats.un.org/unsd/methodology/m49/, "Geographic regions"). Some regions were aggregated to prevent individual identification.

☐ Northern Africa (e.g., Morocco, Egypt, Sudan)
☐ Sub-Saharan Africa (e.g., Nigeria, Cameroon, Kenya, South Africa)
☐ Central America and the Caribbean (e.g., Mexico, Panama, Jamaica)
☐ South America (e.g., Brazil, Honduras, Argentina)
☐ Northern America (e.g., Canada, United States)
☐ Eastern Asia (e.g., PR China, Japan, South Korea)
☐ Western and Central Asia (e.g., Uzbekistan, Armenia, Israel, Saudi Arabia, Türkiye)
☐ Southern Asia (e.g., Iran, Pakistan, India, Afghanistan)
☐ South-Eastern Asia (e.g., Thailand, Singapore, Indonesia)
☐ Eastern Europe (e.g., Ukraine, Poland, Russian Federation, Romania)
☐ Southern Europe (e.g., Serbia, Italy, Portugal, Spain, Greece)
☐ Northern Europe (e.g., Sweden, Estonia, United Kingdom, Iceland)
☐ Western Europe (e.g., Germany, Austria, France)
☐ Oceania (e.g., Australia, New Zealand, Fiji, Guam, Samoa)
☐ I don't know
☐ I don't want to answer
☐ Self-describe:

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Legend: ○ single choice, □ multiple choice.

Page 4 / 5 / 6 (rotated)

How old are you (in years)?
- o 35 or younger
- o 36-50
- o 51 or older
- o I don't want to answer

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Page 4 / 5 / 6 (rotated)

Highest education of the guardian(s) who raised you during youth?
- o None
- o Other school diploma (including "Mittlere Reife", "Hauptschulabschluss" and "Volksschulabschluss")
- o Abitur or equivalent
- o Vocational training ("Ausbildung")
- o Bachelor or equivalent
- o Master or equivalent
- o PhD or equivalent
- o Professor
- o I don't know
- o I don't want to answer

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Page 7 / 8 / 9 (rotated)

Do you consider yourself to have a disability?
- o Yes, with official recognition (includes "Schwerbehindertenausweis" or equivalent)
- o Yes, without official recognition (includes chronic illness, self-identified, or pending diagnosis)
- o No
- o I don't want to answer

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Page 7 / 8 / 9 (rotated)

Which of the following options applies to you?
Please note, each item must be assigned to a box in order to proceed with the survey (drag-and-drop items below).

- Man whose gender identity corresponds to their sex assigned at birth
- Women whose gender identity corresponds to their sex assigned at birth
- Heterosexual
- Homosexual
- Member of the LGBTQIA+ community
  [a person that identifies as lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender, queer, intersex, asexual or as any other identity (+) not encompassed in the short acronym]

Applies to me	Does not apply to me	I don't want to answer

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Legend: ○ single choice, □ multiple choice.

1. Do you practice a religion at work?
Here, we mean rituals or practices that are part of a religion.
- o **No**
  (yet I consider myself religious)
- o **No**, but I would like to
  (I consider myself religious)
- o **Yes**, but I feel restricted in the way I can do that
- o **Yes**
- o **Does not apply to me**
  (I am agnostic, atheist, or do not consider myself religious)
- o **I don't want to answer.**

2. (Optional)
If you like, please indicate the religion you practice.

BACK **NEXT**

Feedback page (optional)

We very much welcome your feedback, suggestions, ideas and criticism.
If you have the time, please add them in the text box below. Please avoid mentioning any identifying details, including the name of your research unit.

BACK **NEXT**

Last page (in case, informed consent is given [Page 2])

Thank you very much for completing this survey!

Please reach out to us anytime in case of questions, criticism, concerns or any requests related to this survey.

You may now close this tab.

Warm regards,

Your [committee] of [home institution]
[URL]
[email address]

Last page (in case, informed consent is not given [Page 2])

Thank you for your time!

You have indicated that you do not wish to participate in the [survey name]. No data has been collected, and your progress has ended. We respect your decision and appreciate your interest in our work. If you declined by mistake, you may return to the Informed Consent page by clicking on the button 'Back' (bottom left corner).

You may now close this tab.

Warm regards,

Your [committee] of [home institution]
[URL]
[email address]

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